

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Winton

Grove House, 27 Hammersmith Grove

London W6 ONE

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Researcher – Graduate: 2027 role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Winton's focus on statistical inference in financial markets describes the work I most enjoy, and its trend-following research is close to the hypothesis testing and backtesting I do myself.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, estimates petro-currencies' oil betas from OPEC announcement-day surprises, tests whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make them smaller, kinked or one-sided, and asks whether any beta that remains survives costs and a White reality check. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for, with a buffer because their edge is only an estimate; a position sized on an uncertain alpha needs the same caution. As Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Winton stands out to me because it has built its business on statistical inference rather than narrative, and it keeps extending that research into new formats, bringing its flagship major-market trend strategy to a US mutual fund for the first time in October 2025. Correcting my CAPM results for running 694 tests at once taught me to distrust any result that has not survived a fair test, which is why my dissertation's predictions are fixed before I test them; I understand that is the standard Winton's researchers work to.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan